Final-years do not need another webinar. They need a project to show.

Who: 2027-batch engineering students at Tier-2/3/4 colleges (all branches).

1. Placement Proof

"Every interviewer asks what I have built with AI. I have only generic mini-projects."

Core Driver

2. Clock Urgency

"My final-year capstone is due, and 60 minutes is something I can commit to during drive season."

Low Friction

3. Collegiate Tribalism

"If my classmates and campus are joining, I will not be the one left behind."

Social Proof

Registration Engine

Outcome hook, zero phone numbers, 20-second form, and immediate 'first project idea' reward.

Squad Race

CHANNEL ARCHITECTURE

500 students will not come from ads. They come from people they trust.

The arithmetic: ₹2,000 at ₹30–₹80 CPR buys ~35 signups. Trusted humans seed; Squad Race multiplies.

RANK 1 • WHATSAPP

Campus Champions

~190

20 student reps post AI-written branch kits into native class groups.

RANK 2 • EMAIL

Placement Cells

~100

300 personalized emails to TPOs & HoDs; official circulars carry authority.

RANK 3 • CLUBS

Tech Communities

~60

GDG on Campus, IEEE, and AI clubs co-post with inter-club challenge.

RANK 4 • PAID TEST

A/B Hook Test

~30

₹600 split across 2 variants to buy learning on winning message.

7-DAY EXECUTION TIMELINE

D1: Asset live, Brief champions · **D2:** TPO email batch 2, Test 1 signals · **D3:** Leaderboard battle shared · **D4 Gate:** Scale winner · **D5:** Branch wave (ECE/Mech) · **D6:** Honest deadline · **D7:** Cohort build

Unit Economics: 380 Direct Seeds + 120 Viral Referrals = 500 Total

Budget: ₹1,000 Vouchers • ₹600 Ad Test • ₹400 Reserve

How 500 happens: 380 seeds plus a 0.24 referral loop.

Total = Seed / (1 - k) = 380 / (1 - 0.24) = 500. Every single rate is an assumption to validate.

Scenario Sensitivity Matrix

SCENARIO	SEED	K-LOOP	TOTAL	STRATEGY / ACTION
Plan (Base)	380	0.24	500	Stay course, monitor D4 gate.
Referral weak	380	0.10	422	Boost prompts; add D5 college bonus.
Seeding weak (-20%)	304	0.24	400	Day-4 rescue: second club push.
Both weak	304	0.10	338	Honest shortfall: focus top 5 colleges.

DAY-4 PACING GATE RULE

If cumulative registrations < 250 by Day 4: trigger rescue levers and deploy ₹400 reserve. If > 290: protect plan and keep reserve unspent.

BUDGET SPLIT (₹2,000 TOTAL)

- ₹1,000: Top 3 referrers (₹500 / ₹300 / ₹200) awarded after attendance.
- ₹600: Paid hook A/B test (Test 1).
- ₹400: Gated rescue reserve.

Daily Pacing: D1: 60 • D2: 130 • D3: 210 • D4: 290 • D5: 370 • D6: 440 • D7: 500

WORKING ASSET & 3 TESTS

I built the engine that makes it happen: Squad Race (live).

Live web app deployed on Vercel with server route handlers, fraud filters, and instant WhatsApp attribution.



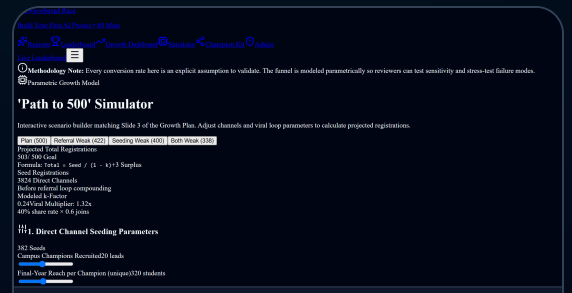
1. 20-Sec Registration



2. College Leaderboard



3. Growth Dashboard



4. 'Path to 500' Simulator

THE 3 EXPERIMENTAL TESTS BUILT-IN:

Test 1 (Hook): Placement-proof vs. Curiosity on 8 class groups + ₹600 ad test. Metric: link-to-reg conversion (≥20% lift wins).

Test 2 (Social): College race rank vs. individual rank card. Metric: 24h WhatsApp share rate and k-factor (≥25% lift keeps race).

Test 3 (Trust): Peer Champion vs. Placement vs. Club via utm_source. Metric: regs per 100 reached (≥1.5× shifts reserve).

Public Asset: https://nxtwave-squad-race.vercel.app

Admin Key: nxtwave_growth_2027

Database: Supabase / Resilient Embedded Relational

REFLECTION & NEXT HORIZON

How I thought.

Judgement over tooling: real decisions, deliberate rejections, and post-campaign completion leaks.

What Changed from First Idea

I started with a classic landing page + Meta ads. The unit arithmetic (₹2,000 buys only 25–65 signups) and public NxtWave workshop reports flipped my plan to trusted human seeding plus a collegiate referral race—turning the asset into the engine.

What I Rejected from AI

- Paid influencer shoutouts (untargeted, bad unit economics).
- Bulk contact scraping (spam, WhatsApp bans, privacy).
- Fake scarcity counters ("only 37 seats left" destroys trust).
- Cash per referral (invites fraud and breaks budget).

With Another 24 Hours

Public reports from a past college workshop showed **1,139 attended but only 42 submitted projects**. Registration is only step 1; project completion is the real leak. I would build a live AI project rubric evaluator giving instant feedback.